

INFORMATION

These activities have always gone down well with my students. The students get a break from text books and worksheets but still have to focus and answer a set of 16 carefully selected questions.

I sometimes have two different treasure hunts running at the same time – one usually being more difficult than the other. In this scenario, some students might get to answer 32 questions. This is a lot of useful question practice, especially when used for a starter or a plenary at the end of a lesson.

ACTIVITY 1: Classroom Treasure Hunt

This is a whole class activity which is useful for revision, for a starter or for a plenary.

The large version of the cards need to be printed (either as A4 or A5) and displayed around the classroom – stuck to walls, windows cupboards, etc. *(I usually save myself time and give the cards to students and ask them to stick them in clearly visible positions around the room)*

You can either print an answer sheet for each student, or they can use plain paper/their exercise books to do the working out and keep a record of their answers.

Playing:

There are 16 cards, each of which has a different answer.

At the top of each card is the answer to one of the other cards (not its own answer).

Students choose any of the cards to start and write the card's letter in one of the circles on their answer sheet.

They answer the question on this first card and look around the room to see which of the other cards has their answer on it – this is the question that they answer next.

The student copies the letter from the second card onto their answer sheet (next to the first letter, going clockwise), they then answer the question and look around the room to find the card that has this answer.

Students repeat the process of writing down a card's letter, answering the question and looking for the next card.

When a student has answered all the questions, they will have a completed loop of letters on their answer sheet. They then use the deciphering table to change the letters from their answers into the letters of the actual message, which is a clue to where the treasure is hidden!

Note that the cards are colour-coded according to difficulty/age at which a topic is usually covered. The colours used approximate to the following:

Red and/or orange – KS2

Green – KS3/Foundation GCSE

Blue – Higher GCSE

Purple – Level 8/9 GCSE.

I would typically print the questions onto pale-coloured card (matching the colour-coding above) so that they can be stored and used again in the future.

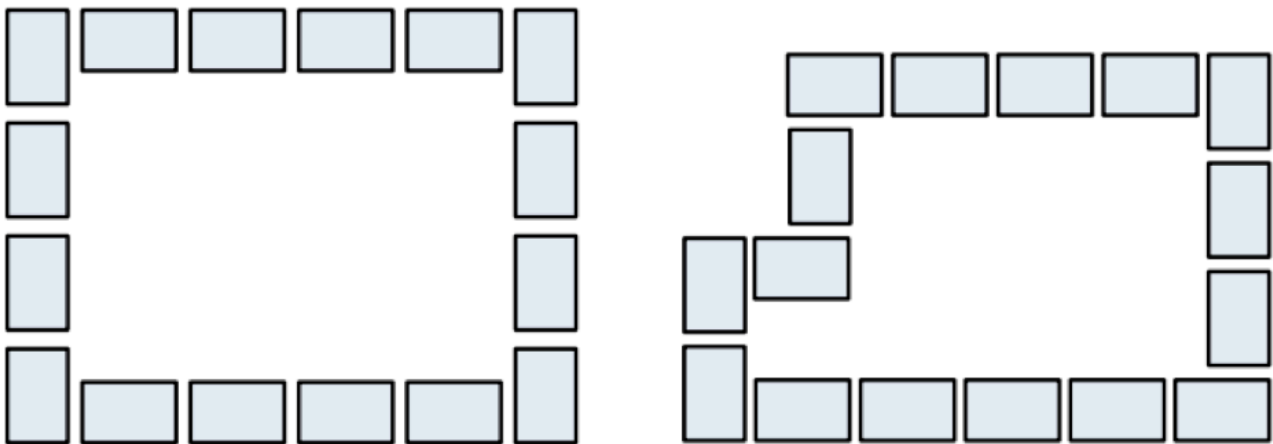
ACTIVITY 2: Loop Cards

This activity is good for individuals and small groups. It is particularly good for one-to-one support or tuition.

I have lots of pre-prepared sets of loop cards which students have previously cut out – I printed them onto pale-coloured card so that they can be used lots of times before getting too tatty. I store them in little plastic bags (from Hobbycraft!), but some sort of clip works well, too.

I give students a shuffled set of loop cards and they sort them into order by working out the answer on one of the cards and looking for that answer on one of the other cards. The card with the previous answer has the question that the student must answer next.

I usually get students to create a sorted pile of cards, writing down the answers as they go, but an alternative is that they arrange the cards in an actual loop on the desk:



Note that when used in this way, deciphering the code is optional.

AN ELEMENT OF COMPETITION:

I have two students of similar ability, then I sometimes give them each a set of identical (shuffled) loop cards and get them to race each other.

The winner is the student who finishes in the fastest time, but I add on time penalties (usually 20 seconds) for each card that does not correctly follow on from the previous one.